

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 005 · HOT

Snyk

Developer Security · Boston, MA / London · Private (~\$7B+; IPO anticipated 2026)

Developer-security leader Snyk is building toward a 2026 IPO with a CMO seat in transition and no motorsport footprint - and the security category on the grid is still empty.

76

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Aston Martin

ACTION HORIZON

6-8 WKS

THE CASE

Snyk is a well-funded developer-security leader (over \$300M ARR) whose CEO, Peter McKay, has publicly flagged a 2026 IPO. Two signals stack up. First, the security category on the F1 grid is uncontested, so a multi-year partnership would give Snyk both enterprise credibility ahead of a listing and ownership of a lane no rival holds. Second, Snyk's brand function is mid-reset: its previous CMO, Jonaki Egenolf, departed for XBOW in November 2025, which means brand and sponsorship strategy is actively being re-decided right now - the ideal moment to plant an idea. The competitive nuance to flag internally: this is the same whitespace JFrog and Sonatype are eyeing, so the category is a race, and whoever signs first owns it.

WHY NOW

Pre-IPO brand-building budgets, an open security category, and a brand leadership reset all coincide. With the CMO seat in transition, the decision is currently closest to the CEO, which both shortens the chain and means the strategic framing set now will shape whoever inherits the role. The window closes the moment a DevSecOps rival commits to a team.

- NEVER ENTERED
- CATEGORY WHITESPACE
- FUNDING EVENT
- NEW LEADERSHIP
- DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY ASTON MARTIN

Aston Martin's CISO-grade gravitas and premium, technically-credible identity place Snyk's 'secure by design' story directly in front of the enterprise security buyers it sells to. If Aston Martin's inventory is constrained, Williams (data/engineering revival) is a credible alternative with the right audience profile.

VALUE TO ASTON MARTIN — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A. Snyk integrates security directly into developer workflows, and an F1 team's expanding in-house software estate is a real testbed and reference deployment. A deal can be built around securing the team's own development pipeline, giving the team genuine operational value and Snyk an authentic 'official developer-security partner' narrative plus CISO-level hospitality - substance on both sides, not signage.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Developer Security Partner tier on Aston Martin, minimum three years, ~\$3-4M/yr, with security-category exclusivity and a working integration into the team's development pipeline.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Peter McKay

CEO, SNYK - VERIFIED (NOTE: CMO SEAT IN TRANSITION AFTER JONAKI EGENOLF'S NOV 2025 DEPARTURE TO XBOW)

CEO and the owner of Snyk's IPO narrative and, currently, its top-level brand decisions while the CMO role is being refilled - which makes him the right entry point today. Approach McKay directly and offer to help shape the sponsorship thesis the incoming CMO will execute. (Egenolf's move to XBOW is itself logged as a separate exec-migration signal.)

OPENING ANGLE

"Peter, with the CMO seat in transition the security-on-the-grid decision sits with you - and JFrog and Sonatype both want that empty slot. First mover owns it for three years, right before your IPO. Worth 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 CEO Peter McKay has flagged a 2026 IPO; the CMO seat is also in transition (Jonaki Egenolf left to XBOW in Nov 2025), so brand strategy is being reset now.	CAPACITY 17 / 20 Multi-billion valuation with \$300M+ ARR (Dec 2024) - well funded for a mid-to-premium tier.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 Developer and application security sits in the same uncontested grid whitespace as JFrog.	URGENCY 13 / 20 If JFrog or Sonatype sign first, the security category locks and Snyk is forced onto a rival team or out.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: an F1 team's growing in-house software estate is a genuine developer-security surface.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO TIMING UNCERTAINTY Brand spend may be deferred until the listing is closer. **Counter:** Sign now to lock category exclusivity at a pre-IPO price; scale activation at the listing.

LEADERSHIP GAP With no sitting CMO, the deal could stall awaiting the new hire. **Counter:** Engage the CEO directly and frame the partnership as a ready-made win to hand the incoming CMO on day one.

SOURCES

- https://snyk.io/about/leadership/
- https://finance.yahoo.com/news/xbow-appoints-former-snyk-veracode-180100481.html
- https://www.morningstar.com/stocks/ipos-make-comeback-these-9-cybersecurity-startups-could-be-next